

SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS



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STACKER.NEWS WEEKLY ZINE



WE MISS YOU, INTERNET

Issue #58

May 17 - May 22

950 541



created by [@plebpoet](#)

and [@k00b](#) supports

Note From The Editor

Inside the issue of SNZ, a good mix of fun and friendly information was spattered across these pages, inspired by you, the stackers.

And another thing I'll say about it: sometimes, you have a bad one. `\\_(\`)/`

BITCOIN HISTORY MONTH ON STACKER NEWS - 400k SATS IN PRIZES!



3451 sats \ 16 comments \ [@Scoresby](#) 18 May
the_stacker_muse bitcoin BooksAndArticles history

June is Bitcoin History Month on Stacker News! 400k sats in prizes!

There are too many Bitcoin stories that have never been written down. Here's your excuse to go deep researching some piece of unknown Bitcoin history everyone needs to know about.

Starting 1 June 2026, Stacker News is looking for original stories and research about pieces of Bitcoin history that haven't been recorded or fully fleshed out yet. To that end, [@siggy47](#), [@totallyhumanwriter](#), [Konsensus](#), [@unschooled](#) and I would like to offer you this chance to win some sats!

Categories

- Bitcoin meme history
- Bitcoin OG biography
- Bitcoin travelogue
- Narrative of spending bitcoin in real life
- Orange-pilling story

Prizes

- 20k sats for each of the top three stories per category
- 100k sats for the best overall story
- prizes will be awarded on 15 July 2026

Judging

[@siggy47](#), [@TotallyHumanWriter](#), [@billytheked](#) and [@Scoresby](#) will select the winners for all prizes based purely on our human judgment.

Entry Guidelines

- stories must be less than 5000 words
- stories must be posted on stacker.news between the first of June and the 30th of June, 2026
- stories must be posted in one or more of the following territories: [~Books_And_Articles](#), [~the_stacker_muse](#), [~bitcoin](#), [~history](#)
- story titles must begin with [HM] (so we know it's a History Month submission)

Examples

If you want a sense of the kind of thing we are looking for, check out these fine Bitcoin history articles:

- The Other Bitcoin Mystery: Where's Friedcat?
- The Mysterious Life And Death Of Mircea Popescu
- The True and Accurate History of the \$5 Wrench

When did the internet become so shit? [A hopeful rant]

5878 sats \ 20 comments \ [@chungkingexpress](#)
20 May culture the_stack_muse AskSN

Stacker News has basically become my new digital home on the internet. This is the first place I visit in the morning and I'm thankful for everyone who contributes to this place.

But when it comes to the "big wide internet" - something is up. It does not feel so big anymore, in fact, it feels pretty damn narrow. Maybe I've become an old man and these are the moans of a millennial longing for the olden days, but I have this overwhelming feeling that somehow over the last few years the internet has started to really suck *hard*.

The Shit List

It's lame how all the social media walled-gardens have become so shit. For me at least there used to be some cool people and communities on Twitter, Instagram, and Reddit - but they have long since succumbed to enshitification.

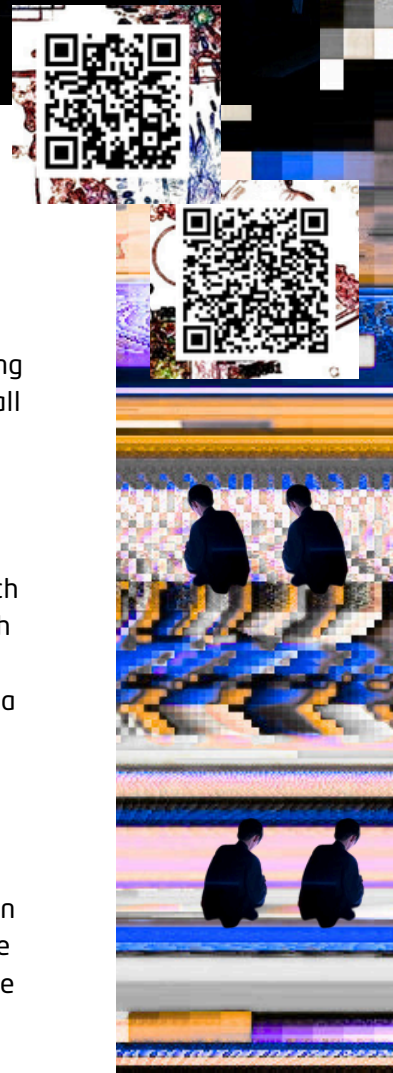
- X/Twitter: has become a completely unusable algo and bot rage machine. *That's the old passage to Ravenholm. We don't go there anymore.* I need to delete my account at some point, but don't want anyone to squat my username.
- Reddit: Some of the ex-pat communities and fringe / political subs were always interesting sources of perspectives and juicy intel, but a lot of it now is basically AI bots talking with each other.
- Instagram: As a visual artist this still plays somewhat of a role in connecting with other creatives and just messaging people etc, but it's nothing like it was 10 years ago.
- Substack: is a more recent player, and this is one I hoped would possibly be able to do something different, given its focus on writing. *I am a writer*, but my "feed" there has for some reason become random click-bait shit and people shilling how to be "authentic and true to yourself" and "how to get more followers". I have come across some interesting people there, but the signal to noise ratio is still far too low. It seems to be going the way of medium with it's own kind of performance culture that is not quite my style (picture this: cupcakes and picnics on the riverside instead of anarchy in the streets)...



Nostalgia 2000

- One of my big old inspirations is old skool forum culture. Everything2.com was the kind place where esoteric ideas and all kinds of "different" people came together. You would never know what you were going to get. I still find myself going there after all these years.
- Superfuture was another inspiration: streetware, tech, travel.
- Of course there is BitcoinTalk, which I was not really a part of in the heyday, but which is the source for a lot of the canonical truth on Bitcoin.
- I never got into 4Chan, but I hear that had a vibe.

If I blend all these together in my nostalgic mind, I imagine a kind of mythical text-based place where you could dive into some deep theology, or getting advice on running a Bitcoin node or hacking a DD-WRT router, or otherwise talking about Shibuya fashion or travel to some random place.





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Overall, there was a culture of self curation, on-topic discussion, and a give-and-take approach to posting and commenting. There was a sense of something special in reading someone else's words, like a letter from an old friend.

Maybe it was the sense of discovery? Even Craigslist has the kind of vibe of "you never quite know what you are going to find" in both a good and a bad way.

Everything now has become so short-form and algorithmic. There has been a big pivot towards video too, which I have never gotten into. Maybe it's too real? On SN I am clearly not private, but I am not quite 100% my "government name" either.

So what is the big idea? Am I not the only one who feels that in the world of social media there is this shallow fucking performance routine that everyone is putting on to drive those engagement metrics and collect followers?

How do you guys feel about this?

Stacker News sits in this goldilocks zone for me. It is still a kind of subculture and there is a gateway to entry - you have to kinda know something about Bitcoin to function here.

Maybe what I am feeling is more broadly the death of subcultures? People have been talking about this for decades, I even interviewed a guy who wrote a book about it.

It seems that now instead of tending to a garden of contributors in the "in-group", it is all about those eyeballs - any eyeballs.

Everywhere else online I see the psychology and click-bait traits trying to play its little tricks, I see those fucking AI tell-tale signs "its not A, it's B" and of course the EM dash.

Hacker News still has some value for me, but it has its own kind of retardation going on when it comes to RealPolitik and Bitcoin and creative stuff.

As for "news" I enjoy reading Zero Hedge from time to time for the latest, but it can be hit and miss.

Where to from here?

Before anyone says Nostr let's be clear it is a protocol not a community. I think it is interesting tech to build a community on but fundamentally you still need the "place and the occasion".

I have my writing and essays and a bunch of other random things I am interested in sharing, but sometimes not quite sure how it fits. Not all of us here are going to be into the exact same things (maybe this is where territories come in?) but there is so much potential.

The reward and incentive mechanism of having to pay sats to post is one of the things that is keeping this place honest I think, without resorting to the kind of bullshit gatekeeping that happens on Hacker News.

I really need to thank @k00b @sox @Scoresby and all the contributors for this. I love this place, it feels like my home on the internet. I had a good chat with k00b a while back about these questions and more.

This is just an open letter, but like, what do you all think?

Where else do you guys still get value from on the "internet"? What are some of your other favourite places that you would be willing to share?

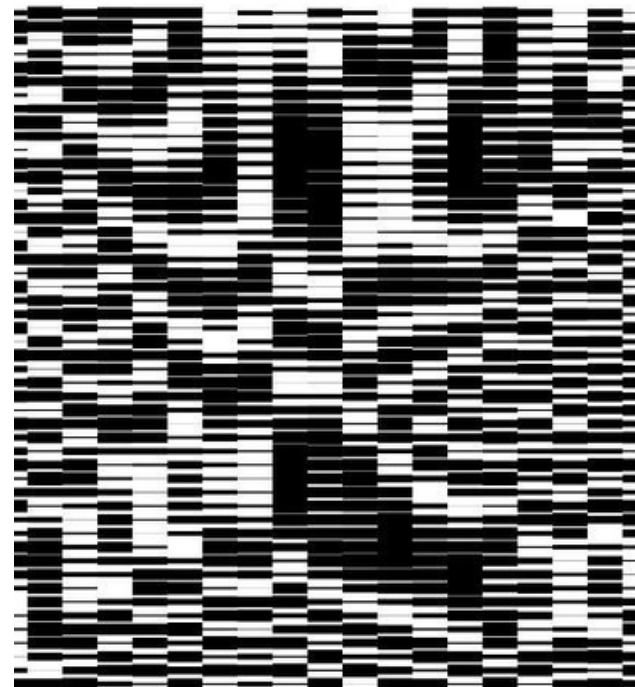


MEME MONDAY

- Top Meme

386 sats \ 5 comments \ @sn 18 May
memes

133 sats \ 0 replies \ @hasherstacker 18 May



Instant Lightning → Debit Card Top-Up Mini App Using Satora.io

6756 sats \ 18 comments \ @rolznz 20 May bitcoin

I built a small PWA for instantly topping up a debit card with bitcoin and make payments with Apple Pay, which helps me live on bitcoin

Before I start: I do pay directly in bitcoin where possible. This is one of my fallback approaches that in my opinion is sustainable.

This is also not a post about KYC or no-KYC, or Apple Pay, or Google Pay, really.

This post is also not about crypto, it's about living on bitcoin in a way that actually has a good user experience.

I have been doing this for a long time with 2fiat card connected to Apple Pay (I have a small PWA for instant 2fiat lightning topups), but after some repeated problems I needed a fallback, and realized Satora enables a nice flow that works with many different debit card providers.

The problem

- I keep funds in a self-custodial bitcoin wallet
- Most merchants still accept only card or fiat payments
- Most debit cards are not bitcoin-native and do not support the lightning network

Satora fixes this with near-instant atomic lightning<->stablecoin swaps. I can keep using bitcoin, and topup my debit card just before I pay.

NWC enables a super-simple interface on my phone that I can open and press one button to top up my debit card from my bitcoin lightning wallet. The swap takes less than 10 seconds, and my debit card balance tops up within a minute.

How It Works

1. Setup once: Input your card's deposit address, network, and currency, then connect your wallet via Nostr Wallet Connect (NWC). This is the only time you are exposed to "crypto". From a UX perspective after that, it's only bitcoin and a USD debit card balance.
2. Swap via [Satora.io](#): Tap "Top Up" to trigger a Lightning-funded swap. BTC is converted and sent to your card's deposit address.
3. Seamless payment: NWC pays the Lightning invoice automatically through a budgeted connection to your lightning wallet.

Questions for people trying to live on bitcoin

1. Do you use a bitcoin/crypto/prepaid card today? Which one?
2. How do you top it up now? What is the annoying part?
3. Do you keep a balance on it, or top up only when needed?
4. What would stop you from testing this with a small amount?

Early Access to the App

Want to be one of the first to try the app? send an email to hello@getalby.com
Your bitcoin stays in your wallet until you need it. Works best with Alby Hub: <https://getalby.com/alby-hub?ref=bitcoin-debit-card>

Why I don't think there will be a secret quantum attack on bitcoin

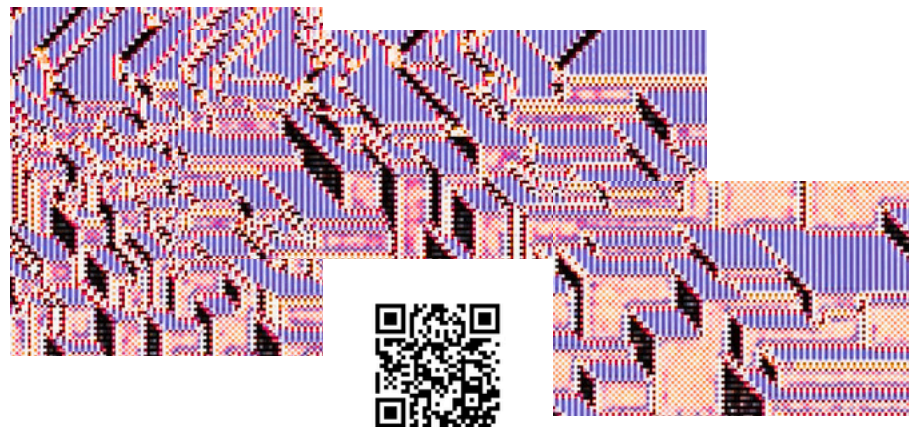
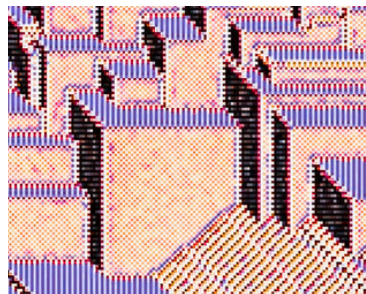
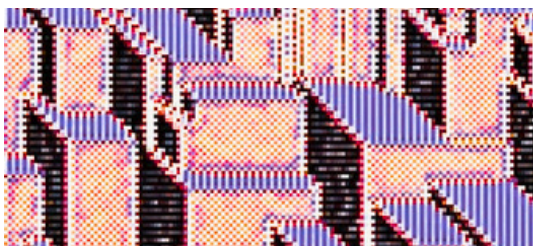
3347 sats \ 16 comments \ [@SimpleStacker](#) 21 May science bitcoin

So there's a number of posts going around again about Quantum ([#1494159](#), [#1494200](#)), all of which are worth a read, and I could have posted this thought in one of those threads, but for visibility and discussion I wanted to make a standalone post about it.

So here's the thought:

A lot of the discussion around a quantum-attack on Bitcoin presupposes the sudden revelation of a Cryptographically Relevant Quantum Computer (CRQC). The idea is that we'll go suddenly from thinking Satoshi's keys are safe to all of a sudden, oops, they're cracked!

But here's why I don't think that'll happen, and why we'll get signals leading up to such an event, and thus the ecosystem will have more lead time than is generally assumed to make decisions regarding quantum security.



It's because: look at the behavior of all the major quantum labs. They jump at the chance to announce any small breakthrough and advancement. And it's totally rational for them to do this, because every new breakthrough triggers a wave of attention and investment and continues the funding cycle. I don't see why that would change leading up to a CRQC. Would labs really start hiding their progress when they start to get closer? I think the incentives to publicize their progress would be even higher. Thus, my thesis is that we'll get plenty of signal as to how close we're getting to CRQC, and we therefore won't be super surprised when it arrives.

The X-factor here is state actors, who may have more of an incentive to keep progress hidden. But for this to cause us to be surprised by the arrival of CRQC would require that the hidden progress of the state actor is significantly more advanced than the publicized progress of the private actors. It's not obvious to me that this would be the case. Moreover, if a state actor benefits from keeping their quantum progress hidden, would the incentive of cracking Bitcoin really be the pivotal factor that causes them to break their silence? Given the current world relevance of Bitcoin, that seems highly unlikely.

So, there are my thoughts in a nutshell. Does anyone want to stress test this idea with me?

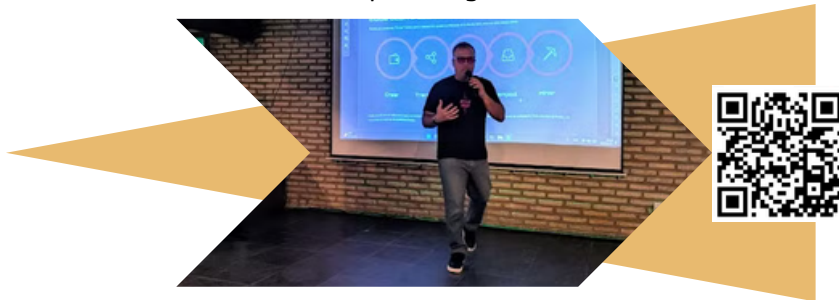
Bitcoin Doesn't Work Like a Bank Account

2928 sats \ 7 comments \ [@softglitter2d](#) 21 May
bitcoin bitcoin_beginners

Yesterday, I had the opportunity to give a presentation on Bitcoin transactions, fees, and privacy for beginner and intermediate users. The experience left me with an interesting realization: many people have bought bitcoin, some even use it regularly, but very few truly understand what happens when they press the “Send” button.

See the presentation (SPA): [Bitcoin Tx's at Bitcoin Talks - Asuncion PY](#)

That is not a criticism. It is perfectly normal.



That's me, walking around and talking about bitcoin txs at Bitcoin Talks

Most of us learned how money works through the traditional banking system. We open an app, look at a balance, and assume that money exists as a number stored inside an account. When we arrive at Bitcoin, we tend to bring that same mental model with us.

But Bitcoin is not a bank account.

And understanding that difference completely changes how we think about transaction fees, privacy, and financial sovereignty.

The Mistake of Thinking in Balances

When you look at a bank account, you see a balance. The bank keeps an internal ledger and simply increases or decreases a number whenever you make a transaction. Bitcoin works differently. The network does not store balances. Instead, it stores pieces of bitcoin called UTXOs (Unspent Transaction Outputs), which are transaction outputs that have not yet been spent.

A simple analogy is physical cash. Imagine you have three fifty-dollar bills. Your total wealth is \$150, but there is no single object worth \$150. There are three separate pieces of value. When you buy something that costs \$80, you do not cut a bill in half. You hand over complete bills and receive change. Bitcoin works in a remarkably similar way. Every time you make a transaction, existing UTXOs are consumed and new UTXOs are created—some for the recipient and usually one for yourself as change. That means a Bitcoin transaction is not about “subtracting from a balance.” It is about destroying old pieces of value and creating new ones.

Where Transaction Fees Come From

Another assumption inherited from the banking world is that transaction costs depend on the amount of money being sent. In Bitcoin, that is not how it works. The network does not charge based on the amount of bitcoin you move. It charges based on the amount of block space your transaction occupies.

A transaction moving 0.001 BTC can cost exactly the same as one moving 1 BTC if both consume the same amount of space. What determines that space is primarily the number of inputs and outputs involved. The more UTXOs you need to spend, the larger your transaction becomes, and the more fees you may need to pay to compete for inclusion in the next block. ...

The Mempool: Bitcoin's Waiting Room

When you send a Bitcoin transaction, it does not immediately appear in the blockchain. It first enters the mempool. You can think of the mempool as a giant waiting room shared by thousands of nodes around the world. Valid transactions wait there until a miner chooses to include them in a block. Because block space is limited, miners generally prioritize transactions offering the highest fee rate per unit of space.

There is no central authority assigning priority. There is simply an open market where users compete for limited space inside blocks. Understanding this mechanism helps users make better decisions about when to transact and how much fee they should pay. ...